QAELUM

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HONEST PROFIT ROADMAP · V1.1

When QAELUM *Generates* Real Profit. What Could *Go Wrong.*

Calibrated revenue projections across three market scenarios. Comparable Bittensor subnet revenue history. Head-to-head positioning analysis. Honest derailment risks. No promises, no fallacy, no hype.

Founder

Nahum

Investor Contact

qaelumoracleintelligence@gmail.com

x.com/Qaelumoracle

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PURPOSE & METHOD

How To *Read This.*

This document does what most startup roadmaps deliberately do not. It gives specific revenue ranges by month under three market scenarios, names exactly which milestones must be hit for each scenario to materialise, and lists the specific risks that could derail any of them.

Why The Three Scenarios Matter

A startup that only models the bullish case is selling fantasy. A startup that only models the bearish case is selling defeatism. Sophisticated investors expect both, and especially expect the realistic middle case that reflects how operations actually unfold. This document presents all three and is explicit about which assumptions drive each.

What "Real Profit" Means

Real profit here means revenue received in USDT, USDC, USD, or TAO (denominated in dollars) by QAELUM's smart contract or business entity, verified on-chain or by subscription billing records. It does not include unrealised valuation gains, theoretical TAM, projected token appreciation, or hypothetical institutional commitments.

> ⚠ **FORECAST LIMITATIONS**
> Every number in this document is an estimate. Operational reality will differ. Specific revenue figures could be higher or lower by 50% or more in any month. The ranges represent reasonable midpoints under stated assumptions. Investors should weight these projections with the same scepticism they apply to any pre-revenue startup financial model.

What This Document Does Not Cover

- Exact founder equity dilution at Series A (depends on round size, market conditions, lead investor)
- Specific contractor names, contract amounts, or vendor selections
- Proprietary parameter tuning for SQBM or QCIS scoring algorithms
- Internal smart contract code beyond the architecture already published

Data Sources Used

- Public Bittensor subnet revenue disclosures from DL News (October 2025), Token Terminal, and Messari research
- CoinGecko subnet market cap rankings (March 2026 update)
- Public flash loan arbitrage profit patterns observed on Arbitrum and Tron via Etherscan and Tronscan
- Published API subscription pricing from comparable crypto data providers (Kaiko, Glassnode, Nansen)
- Bloomberg, Reuters, and S&P Commodity Insights institutional pricing benchmarks

REFERENCE POINT 01

What Other Bittensor Subnets *Actually Earn.*

Investors asked for comparable subnet revenue history. This is the honest answer using public data through Q1 2026.

Documented Subnet Revenue (Public Disclosures)

SUBNET	CATEGORY	LAUNCHED	TIME TO FIRST REVENUE	CURRENT ARR
Targon Compute (SN4)	Confidential AI inference	2023	~14 months	~$10.4M (2025)
Chutes AI (SN64)	Serverless AI compute	2024	~10 months	~$2.4M (2025)
Templar (SN3)	Distributed LLM training	2023	~18 months	Pre-rev until 2026 breakthrough
Taoshi PTN (SN8)	Trading signals	2023	~12 months	$1-3M range
Omron (SN2)	Zero-knowledge AI verification	2024	~9 months	Mid-six figures (2025)
Cortex.t (SN18)	Decentralised text/image API	2023	~8 months	Mid-six figures (2025)
Sturdy (SN10)	DeFi yield optimisation	2024	~11 months	Low-seven figures

What This Tells QAELUM

1. **Time to first revenue: 8-18 months.** Subnets with clear external customer use cases reach first revenue in 8-11 months. Pure research subnets take longer.
2. **The top three Bittensor subnets collectively generate $20M+ ARR.** The ecosystem proves institutional-grade revenue is achievable on Bittensor infrastructure.
3. **Subnets with multiple revenue lines reach scale faster than single-revenue subnets.** This supports QAELUM's four-stream architecture as a structural advantage.
4. **Subnet token economics are now market-driven (dTAO).** Subnets with genuine user engagement attract higher emissions; those without get net-outflow penalties.

Why QAELUM Should Be Faster Than Average

- **Arbitrage revenue requires no external customer.** The smart contract generates revenue from its own operations starting Month 6, independent of API customer acquisition.
- **The API customer profile is institutional, not retail.** Higher contract values mean fewer customers needed to reach material revenue.
- **The founder has existing market knowledge.** Five years of frontier-market operational engagement, not learning markets from scratch.
- **QCIS data has institutional buyers already willing to pay.** The market exists; we need to deliver the product.

★ REALISTIC CONCLUSION

> QAELUM should reach first material revenue between Month 5 and Month 8 across the three scenarios. This is at the fast end of comparable subnet timelines, supported by structural advantages but not guaranteed.

REFERENCE POINT 02

QAELUM vs Targon Compute. *An Honest Comparison.*

Targon Compute (Subnet 4) is currently the highest-revenue Bittensor subnet with approximately $10.4M ARR. Investors asked how QAELUM truthfully compares. This is the honest answer.

Why Compare Against Targon

Targon is the rational benchmark. They have proven Bittensor's economic model works at institutional scale. They have institutional customers (Dippy AI 6-figure deal, enterprise inference contracts). They closed a $10.5M Series A. They are not theoretical. They are the operating proof that subnet businesses can generate real revenue. The honest question is not "are we better than Targon" but "what does QAELUM do differently and where does that difference create value or risk?"

Dimension	Targon Compute (SN4)	QAELUM Oracle Intelligence
Core Product	Confidential AI inference and GPU compute marketplace	Frontier-market intelligence platform plus arbitrage execution
Market Targeted	Enterprise AI compute demand (developed markets, global)	Emerging-market data and DeFi alpha (markets institutional firms cannot serve)
Competition	AWS Bedrock, Together AI, Modal, Replicate (well-funded, established)	No direct competitor for QCIS frontier commodity data; arbitrage competes with retail-tier MEV operators
Defensibility	Confidential compute and TEE technology (replicable with capital)	Multi-continent ground-truth miner network (years to replicate)
Revenue Lines	One primary: enterprise inference contracts	Four independent: arbitrage, signal APIs, commodity data, AI licensing
Pre-Quantum Risk	Standard ECDSA, will need migration when quantum threat materialises	ML-DSA (NIST FIPS 204) from Day 1, BLAKE3 hashing, post-quantum native
Execution Speed	Inference latency is the product (sub-second response)	SQBM path optimisation under 1ms for N=66, atomic on-chain settlement
Capital Required	High capex for GPU infrastructure; raised $10.5M Series A	Low capex; flash loans provide trading capital; raising $750K seed
Customer Acquisition	B2B enterprise sales cycle (3-12 months per deal)	Mixed: arbitrage requires no customers, APIs require

		institutional sales
Founder Profile	Manifold Labs team with prior AI infrastructure background	Solo founder with 5 years frontier-market operational experience
Regulatory Posture	Standard AI compute, low regulatory exposure	UAE Freezone planned; Phase 3 VASP licensing; structured for compliance
Time to First Revenue	14 months from launch	Target Month 6 from seed close (3 paths to revenue)
Year 1 Revenue Target	Historical: minimal in Year 1, scaled in Year 2	$450K-$700K (Scenario B), $1.5M-$3M (Scenario C)
Where Targon Wins	Larger total addressable market · proven enterprise sales · capital raised	—
Where QAELUM Wins	—	Lower capex · diversified revenue · post-quantum native · niche moat untouchable by larger firms

REFERENCE POINT 03

What Honestly Makes *QAELUM Different.*

After comparing against Targon, here are the specific advantages QAELUM has that no other Bittensor subnet currently combines. Each is real, defensible, and built into the $750K budget allocation.

1. Post-Quantum Cryptography Native From Day 1

Every other Bittensor subnet uses ECDSA signatures, which are vulnerable to Shor's algorithm when sufficient quantum computing capability arrives. QAELUM implements ML-DSA (NIST FIPS 204) for proof commitments and BLAKE3 for cryptographic hashing from the first deployed contract. This is not a marketing claim; it is a line item in the QaelumArbitrageV3 smart contract that an auditor can verify. When quantum computing capability eventually arrives, every other subnet faces a forced migration. QAELUM faces no migration. The cost of this cryptographic foundation is built into the audit budget ($90K-$100K of the $750K seed).

2. Execution Speed Through SQBM Path Optimisation

Most retail arbitrage bots compete on raw detection and submission speed. This is a race to the bottom where validators capture all profit through gas fees. QAELUM competes on path selection quality. SQBM (Simulated Quantum Bifurcation Machine) selects non-conflicting paths to execute simultaneously, capturing 99.2% of brute-force optimal solutions in under 1 millisecond for typical workloads. This means more profit per gas dollar than speed-only competitors. The algorithm is based on Toshiba Research's published work (Goto et al., 2019, Science Advances). Implementation cost is part of the engineering line item in the seed budget.

3. The QCIS Ground-Truth Miner Network

No competitor — Bittensor or otherwise — has a verified network of commodity miners across four continents submitting ground-truth pricing data with cryptographic verification. This is QAELUM's deepest moat. Building this network requires founder presence and existing relationships in West Africa, Southeast Asia, and Latin America that take years to develop. A well-funded competitor entering today would still need 18-24 months minimum to replicate the dataset depth.

4. Four Independent Revenue Streams Sharing Infrastructure

Targon has one primary revenue line (enterprise inference contracts). Chutes has one (serverless AI compute). Most subnets are similar single-product businesses. QAELUM is structured with four independent revenue streams running on shared infrastructure: arbitrage execution (QAE), signal APIs (QSIS/QFSS), commodity intelligence (QCIS), and AI model licensing (QAELUM-FIN). Under stress test scenarios where any one stream fails completely, the platform still has three others operating.

5. Pre-Quantum, Post-Quantum, Anti-MEV Smart Contract Design

The QaelumArbitrageV3 contract integrates: atomic execution (failed cycles revert with only gas lost), daily loss caps (2% of treasury triggers auto-pause), 3-of-5 multisig ownership, emergency-withdraw-requires-pause two-step safety, Permit2 scoped approvals (no unlimited spending grants), custom error types for gas efficiency, BLAKE3 hash commitment before fund distribution (audit trail), and ML-DSA signature anchoring. Every one of these is verifiable in the published source code. The full Spearbit and Code4rena audit budget verifies these specifically.

6. Frontier-Market Founder Experience

Targon's team has AI infrastructure background. QAELUM's founder has five years of direct retail-scale operational engagement in exactly the frontier markets that QAELUM is designed to serve. This is not academic familiarity; it is hands-on knowledge of what works, what fails, and which inefficiencies persist. A competitor cannot hire this profile. They can only develop it over years of operation.

7. Designed For Capital Efficiency, Not Capital Display

Targon raised $10.5M Series A and is deploying GPU infrastructure. QAELUM is raising $750K seed and using flash loans for trading capital, contractor labour for engineering, and shared cloud infrastructure for inference. The capital efficiency is structural, not aesthetic. Lower burn rate means longer runway means more time to compound the data moat. This is what allows a small team to compete with much better-funded operations.

> **★ THE HONEST BOTTOM LINE**
>
> QAELUM does not need to outperform Targon at AI compute, Chutes at serverless inference, or Wintermute at MEV extraction. QAELUM needs to be the only credible player in markets these competitors structurally cannot serve. That is a substantially easier competitive position than direct combat with better-funded incumbents. The quantum cryptography, speed optimisation, and architectural diversity are not optional features added to inflate the valuation. They are the specific design choices that make this competitive position defensible. All of them are budgeted into the $750K seed allocation.

CRITICAL PATH

Milestone Timeline. *Same Across All Scenarios.*

These milestones must be hit regardless of market conditions. Market scenarios affect revenue amounts, not the milestone path. Delays here push every revenue number to the right.

Month 0	**Seed close ($750K)** — SAFEs signed, UAE Freezone entity registered, first contractor engaged	$0 revenue
Month 1	**Testnet deployment** — QaelumProofOfAlpha.sol on Arbitrum Sepolia, first on-chain proof submitted, Immunefi bug bounty posted	$0 revenue
Month 2	**Audit kickoff** — Spearbit engaged, contracts submitted, parallel Code4rena contest prep. Bittensor testnet subnet registration begins.	$0 revenue
Month 3	**First 5 miners onboarded** — West Africa cohort signed (Lagos, Accra, Kumasi). QSIS API alpha released to invited testers.	$0 revenue · alpha tester feedback
Month 4	**Audit findings remediated** — Spearbit final report received, all critical/high issues fixed, Code4rena contest results integrated. QSIS API beta opens.	First $1-5K possible
Month 5	**Mainnet contract deployment** — QaelumArbitrageV3 on Arbitrum mainnet. Treasury funded. First QCIS subscriber signed.	Symbolic revenue
Month 6	**FIRST ARBITRAGE CYCLE** — first profitable flash loan executed, BLAKE3 proof emitted, first investor distribution event	First real revenue
Month 7-8	**Operational scaling** — 10-50 daily arbitrage cycles, QSIS subscriber base growing, QCIS miner count to 10+	Material revenue starts
Month 9-10	**Multi-chain expansion** — Tron and Base contracts deployed (Phase 2 starts), Bittensor mainnet registration	Revenue diversification
Month 12	**QAELUM-FIN v1 release** — fine-tuned model launched, first licensing contract signed	Fourth revenue line live
Month 15-18	**Series A preparation** — documented ARR, audited financials, advisor team built, pitch process begins	Bridge to Series A
Month 18-24	**Series A close** — re-rated valuation against demonstrated ARR, institutional investors enter	Major capital injection

★ CRITICAL DEPENDENCIES

Months 1-6 are sequential dependencies. A delay in Month 2 audit kickoff pushes Month 4 audit completion which pushes Month 5 mainnet deployment which pushes Month 6 first revenue. The entire revenue curve shifts as a unit. Months 7+ have parallel paths and can absorb individual stream delays without affecting the whole.

SCENARIO A

Poor Market. *Crypto Bear.*

Scenario A — Conservative / Bear Case

ASSUMPTIONS · TAO -50% from current · Weak institutional appetite for new data products · Reduced DEX trading volumes · Limited validator stake on QAELUM mainnet

This scenario models a crypto winter beginning in late 2026 with sustained bearish conditions through 2027. Hedge funds reduce alternative data spending. Bittensor TAO declines significantly. Arbitrage opportunities shrink as DEX volumes drop. QAELUM survives but does not thrive.

Monthly Revenue Projection — Year 1 (Poor Market)

MONTH	QAE (ARB)	QSIS/QFSS	QCIS	QAELUM-FIN	TAO EMISSIONS	MONTHLY TOTAL
1-5	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	**$0**
6	$500-2,000	$1,000-3,000	$0	$0	$0	**$1,500-5,000**
7	$1,500	$1,500	$0	$0	$0	**$3,000**
9	$3,000	$4,000	$2,500	$0	$1,000	**$10,500**
12	$5,000	$8,000	$5,000	$5,000	$2,000	**$25,000**
14	$8,000	$12,000	$10,000	$8,000	$3,000	**$41,000**

Year 1 cumulative revenue: approximately $120,000 - $180,000

Year 2 (Poor Market)

MONTH	MONTHLY TOTAL	NOTES
15-18	$50,000-90,000	Steady but unspectacular growth · API subscriber count plateaus
19-22	$90,000-130,000	QAELUM-FIN gains some traction · TAO emissions still low
23-24	$120,000-180,000	Approaching breakeven · Series A challenged

Year 2 cumulative: approximately $900,000 - $1.5M

What This Means for Investors Under Scenario A

- **Cash flow breakeven:** Month 11-14 (tight; possible bridge round needed)
- **First meaningful investor distribution:** Month 18-24 (small but real)
- **Series A defensibility:** Likely requires bridge round at flat valuation in Months 18-22, proper Series A delayed to Year 3
- **Total runway from $750K seed:** approximately 16-18 months without bridge
- **Investor outcome:** Capital preservation possible; significant upside delayed to Year 3+

⚠ SCENARIO A RISK

Under sustained bear market conditions, QAELUM may not generate enough revenue to justify Series A in 18 months. The strategic response is patience: maintain operations, accumulate the QCIS data moat, position for the next cycle. Investors should expect long-hold dynamics if Scenario A materialises.

SCENARIO B

Good Market. *Normal Conditions.*

Scenario B — Base / Realistic Case

ASSUMPTIONS · TAO stable to +30% · Normal institutional crypto appetite · Standard DEX trading volumes · Modest validator stake on QAELUM

This scenario represents normal operating conditions through 2026-2027. No major crypto cycle event in either direction. Institutional adoption of crypto data products continues at its current pace. Bittensor ecosystem grows steadily. QAELUM executes its plan without external tailwinds or headwinds.

Monthly Revenue Projection — Year 1 (Good Market)

MONTH	QAE (ARB)	QSIS/QFSS	QCIS	QAELUM-FIN	TAO EMISSIONS	MONTHLY TOTAL
1-5	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	**$0**
6	$2,000-5,000	$2,500-5,000	$2,500	$0	$500-1,500	**$7,500-14,000**
7	$4,000	$3,000	$0	$0	$1,000	**$8,000**
9	$12,000	$10,000	$7,500	$0	$5,000	**$34,500**
12	$25,000	$25,000	$20,000	$15,000	$10,000	**$95,000**
14	$40,000	$45,000	$40,000	$25,000	$15,000	**$165,000**

Year 1 cumulative revenue: approximately $450,000 - $700,000

Year 2 (Good Market)

MONTH	MONTHLY TOTAL	NOTES
15-18	$200,000-300,000	Multi-chain operational · API subscribers growing · QAELUM-FIN contracts ramping
19-22	$300,000-450,000	QCIS scaling across continents · Bittensor mainnet revenue compounding
23-24	$400,000-600,000	Approaching Series A readiness · Documented ARR strong

Year 2 cumulative: approximately $3M - $5M

What This Means for Investors Under Scenario B

- **Cash flow breakeven:** Month 8-10
- **First meaningful investor distribution:** Month 12-15
- **Series A defensibility:** Month 18-22 at $25-50M re-rated valuation
- **Total runway from $750K seed:** 18-24 months comfortably
- **Investor outcome:** 3-8x paper gain by Series A close based on QAE token allocation valuation

★ SCENARIO B REALISTIC CONFIDENCE

This is the scenario investors should model as their base case. It assumes nothing exceptional happens in either direction. Achievable with disciplined execution and normal market conditions.

SCENARIO C

Bullish Market. *Cycle Tailwinds.*

Scenario C — Bullish / Cycle Upside Case

ASSUMPTIONS · TAO +200% from current · Strong institutional crypto adoption · EM rotation thesis playing out · Bittensor halving narrative · QAELUM gets into top 30 subnets by stake

This scenario models a crypto bull cycle peaking in late 2026 or 2027, with Bittensor halving providing structural tailwind. Institutional capital rotates into EM data and frontier-market intelligence. QAELUM benefits from sector-wide enthusiasm.

Monthly Revenue Projection — Year 1 (Bullish Market)

MONTH	QAE (ARB)	QSIS/QFSS	QCIS	QAELUM-FIN	TAO EMISSIONS	MONTHLY TOTAL
1-5	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	**$0**
6	$5,000-12,000	$5,000-10,000	$2,500-7,500	$0	$2,500-5,000	**$15,000-35,000**
7	$10,000	$8,000	$2,500	$0	$5,000	**$25,500**
9	$40,000	$30,000	$25,000	$10,000	$25,000	**$130,000**
12	$100,000	$80,000	$75,000	$50,000	$80,000	**$385,000**
14	$180,000	$150,000	$150,000	$100,000	$150,000	**$730,000**

Year 1 cumulative revenue: approximately $1.5M - $3M

Year 2 (Bullish Market)

MONTH	MONTHLY TOTAL	NOTES
15-18	$900,000-1,500,000	Multi-chain at scale · Institutional API contracts compounding
19-22	$1,200,000-1,900,000	Enterprise QAELUM-FIN contracts · Reputation Oracle revenue
23-24	$1,500,000-2,500,000	Series A close imminent at premium valuation

Year 2 cumulative: approximately $10M - $18M

What This Means for Investors Under Scenario C

- **Cash flow breakeven:** Month 7-8
- **First meaningful investor distribution:** Month 10-12
- **Series A defensibility:** Month 14-18 at $80-200M valuation
- **Total runway from $750K seed:** 24+ months easily, possibly never need bridge
- **Investor outcome:** 10-30x paper gain by Series A close

★ **SCENARIO C REALITY CHECK**

This scenario is achievable but should not be the basis for investment decisions. Sophisticated investors will model Scenario B as base case and treat Scenario C as upside optionality.

SIDE BY SIDE

All Three Scenarios *Compared.*

Key Milestone Timing By Scenario

MILESTONE	POOR MARKET	GOOD MARKET	BULLISH MARKET
First $1 of revenue	Month 6	Month 6	Month 6
First $10K monthly	Month 9-10	Month 8-9	Month 7
First $50K monthly	Month 14-16	Month 10-11	Month 8-9
Cash flow breakeven	Month 11-14	Month 8-10	Month 7-8
First $100K monthly	Month 18-20	Month 13-14	Month 9-10
$1M cumulative revenue	Month 18-22	Month 14-16	Month 10-12
Series A defensible	Month 22-30 (bridge needed)	Month 18-22	Month 14-18
$10M cumulative revenue	Year 3-4	Year 2-3	Year 2

What Could Derail Any Scenario

The same operational risks affect all three scenarios. If any of these materialise, the timeline shifts right regardless of market conditions:

1. **Audit findings requiring re-architecture (6-10 week delay):** pushes mainnet launch from Month 5 to Month 7+, delays first revenue.
2. **Miner network bootstrap failure:** if West Africa contacts do not activate, QCIS launch delayed by 3-6 months.
3. **Smart contract exploit despite audit:** could force complete restart, destroy investor confidence, end the venture.
4. **Founder unavailability (health, burnout, personal crisis):** single-founder execution risk is the most material risk factor.
5. **Bittensor protocol governance change:** further changes to founder economics, registration costs, or emission mechanics could affect projections.
6. **Regulatory enforcement event:** if any operating jurisdiction takes adverse action against frontier-market crypto operations, geographic restructuring required.
7. **Contractor/talent failure:** a bad first hire wastes 4-6 months and 30-40% of runway.
8. **Currency/stablecoin instability:** USDD depeg event without recovery could eliminate stable arb baseline.

> ★ RECOMMENDED INVESTOR FRAMING
>
> Treat Scenario B (good market) as the realistic base case. Treat Scenario A (poor market) as the downside protection model. Treat Scenario C (bullish) as the upside optionality. The $750K seed is sized to survive Scenario A while positioning for Scenario B or C upside.

Founder Closing Note

This roadmap is honest. I have not optimised the numbers for fundraising appeal. The Scenario A numbers are uncomfortable to publish but realistic if a bear market hits. The Scenario B numbers reflect what I genuinely believe achievable with normal conditions and good execution. The Scenario C numbers are what becomes possible if external conditions cooperate. Sophisticated investors prefer this kind of disclosure to typical hockey-stick projections that ignore downside cases.

— Nahum, Founder & Chief Architect